KORTEX

The GEO Audit Checklist

The 27 checks we run before any engagement

Give each check a pass, a partial or a fail. Fix the Access group first, then Pages. A pass on every check does not guarantee citations: no engine publishes a full recipe. A fail in Access means the rest cannot work.

KORTEX, Fès, Morocco. Hamza Bentarhlia.

Access

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
1	**robots.txt allows the crawlers you want on public pages**	Open /robots.txt. Check that no rule blocks Googlebot, PerplexityBot or the other crawlers you want on your public paths.	Public paths are allowed, private paths are listed, and the sitemap is declared.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
2	**Your firewall or CDN does not block those crawlers**	Check bot-protection and firewall rules. Compare your server logs with the crawlers' published user agents and IP ranges.	Requests from the crawlers you allow return 200, not a challenge page or a 403.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
3	**Your key pages are indexable**	Inspect each key page in Search Console. Look for noindex, a canonical pointing elsewhere, or a page that is not indexed.	Every key page is indexed, with a self-referencing canonical and no noindex.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
4	**The core text is in the HTML before any script runs**	Load the page with JavaScript off, or view the raw source. Check that headings and body text are present.	The full answer is readable without scripts.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
5	**The sitemap lists only indexable 200 URLs**	Fetch /sitemap.xml and request a sample of its URLs. Look for redirects, 404s and noindex pages.	Every URL returns 200, is indexable, and carries its language alternates.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
6	**No redirect chains or soft 404s on money pages**	Request your pricing, contact and solution pages with and without the trailing slash. Follow every redirect.	One hop at most, always to the final page.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

Pages

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
7	**Each key page opens with a direct answer**	Read the first two or three sentences under the title. Ask whether they would stand alone if quoted.	The answer comes first, then the detail.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
8	**One clear page for each buyer question**	List your buyer questions and the page that answers each. Look for several near-identical pages on the same intent.	One strong page per question, with no near-duplicates.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
9	**First-hand material is on the page**	For each page, name the one thing it contains that a generic article could not: your data, a case, a decision.	You can name it in one sentence. If you cannot, the page is not ready.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
10	**Headings state something and follow a clean order**	List the H1 and H2 headings of a page. Check that each says something and that no level is skipped.	One H1, headings that carry a claim, no skipped levels.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
11	**Pages show a publication date and a last-updated date**	Check the visible dates on articles and key pages. Compare them with the dates in the markup.	Both dates are visible and match.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
12	**Claims cite primary sources**	Pick every statistic or statement about how a platform works. Check that it links to the primary source.	Each one links to a page you opened, or is removed.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

Entity and trust

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
13	**One spelling of the company name everywhere**	Search your site, profiles and press mentions for variants of your company name.	One spelling, used the same way on every page and profile.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
14	**Articles name a real author with an author page**	Open three articles. Check for a named author and a page about them.	A named person, a role and a track record on a linked page.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
15	**The about page says who you are, where and what you do**	Read your about page as a stranger. Check that it names people, a place and the service.	A stranger can describe your company correctly after reading it.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
16	**Contact details are real and easy to find**	Find your email, address or contact page from any page in two clicks.	A working contact route on every page footer.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
17	**Linked profiles are yours and consistent**	Open every social or directory profile you link. Compare names, descriptions and links.	Real profiles only, with the same name and description.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
18	**Key terms are named the same way across the site**	List the five terms you use most. Search the site for synonyms for each.	One term per idea, on every page.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

Structured data

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
19	**Organization and WebSite markup exist and are correct**	Run a key page through a structured data validator. Check name, URL, logo and contact point.	Valid markup that matches your real details.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
20	**Article and author markup matches the visible page**	Compare the headline, dates and author in the markup with what a reader sees.	Every value in the markup is visible on the page.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
21	**FAQ and term markup appears only where the content is visible**	For each page with FAQ markup, check that the same questions and answers are visible.	Questions and answers in the markup equal the visible ones.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
22	**Markup is validated on every release**	Check whether a script or a step in your release process validates the structured data.	A failing check stops a release that has broken markup.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

Measurement

#	CHECK	HOW TO CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
23	**A written list of buyer questions exists**	Check for a list of the questions buyers ask in the words they use, drawn from sales calls and support.	A frozen list, with the exact wording kept month to month.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
24	**A baseline run is logged in each engine**	Check for a dated log of those questions run in each engine you care about.	Date, engine, surface, question, named, cited, others cited.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
25	**Search Console's generative AI report is checked**	Open Search Console and find the report on generative AI features. Note what it shows for your site.	Someone reads it every month.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
26	**The sources cited instead of you are recorded**	For every question where you are absent, note which pages were cited and what they contain.	You know which competitor pages own which questions.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail
27	**A monthly re-run date is set and owned**	Check that a person and a date are assigned to repeat the run each month.	A named owner and a recurring date, with trends read over three runs.	☐ Pass ☐ Partial ☐ Fail

Score sheet

GROUP	PASSES	
Access	_____	of 6
Pages	_____	of 6
Entity and trust	_____	of 6
Structured data	_____	of 4
Measurement	_____	of 5

Want it done for you?

The AI Citation Audit runs these checks on your site and tests 40 buyer questions in ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews. 490 euros, delivered in 5 business days, credited in full against your first month.

kortexlab.me/audit